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BIOTECH & HEALTH



Linda Yaccarino joins
health tech platform
eMed as CEO after
leaving X

Linda Yaccarino's next role after [departing](#) X as CEO will be another chief executive role at [eMed Population Health](#), an AI startup building a tech platform for patients using GLP-1s.

Yaccarino was a longtime advertising executive at NBCUniversal but left to join X as CEO for two years, where she managed to have a [positive impact](#) on the social network's troubled ad revenue model, despite her and Elon Musk's shared approach to minimizing content moderation.

Though Yaccarino does not have experience in health tech, eMed said in a [press release](#) that they sought her out for her [undeniable ability to negotiate new partnerships](#) — it certainly also helps that her tenure at X made her well-known in the tech world, drawing more eyes toward the startup.

eMed [previously](#) produced a tech platform that was designed to be used with at-home COVID-19 rapid antigen tests, guiding users through the process of administering these tests properly. Now eMed is focused on GLP-1s, the class of drugs like Ozempic, which can be used for both weight management and treatment of type 2 diabetes.

"To be a leader in today's healthcare marketplace, companies need to have a fearless tenacity that allows them to not only grow, but to also be brave enough to step forward and redefine an entire industry," Yaccarino [said](#) in a press release. "We are

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very well-positioned to be that tenacious leader, striving toward our ultimate goal of improving global healthcare outcomes through our groundbreaking services and platforms.”

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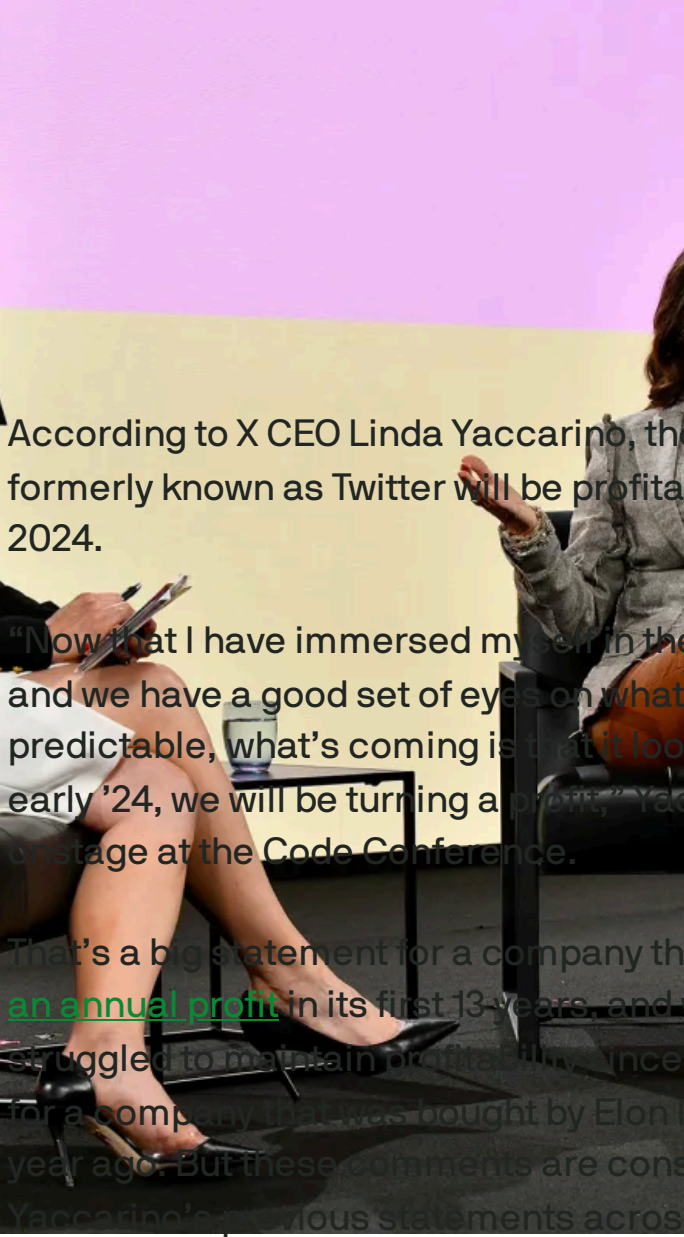
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X will be profitable in 2024, CEO claims in tense interview



According to X CEO Linda Yaccarino, the company formerly known as Twitter will be profitable by early 2024.

“Now that I have immersed myself in the business, and we have a good set of eyes on what is predictable, what’s coming is that it looks like in early ’24, we will be turning a profit,” Yaccarino said onstage at the Code Conference.

That’s a big statement for a company that didn’t turn an annual profit in its first 13 years, and which has struggled to maintain profitability since — let alone for a company that was bought by Elon Musk only a year ago. But these comments are consistent with Yaccarino’s previous statements across the few

months since she became CEO. In August, she said on CNBC that X was “pretty close to breakeven” in terms of operational run rate. In July, she stated in a leaked memo that X usage was at an all-time high.

Yaccarino said onstage today that, “90% of the top 100 advertisers have returned to the platform in the last 12 weeks alone.”

X also reduced its spending by cutting the size of its staff from 8,000 to about 1,500; further, laid-off employees still have not been paid severance. X is also facing multiple lawsuits over not paying rent for office space in several countries.

Yaccarino added that the time users spend on X has gone up since June. But the interviewer, CNBC’s Julia Boorstin, pushed back on such claims about user engagement, pointing to data from app

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analytics firm Apptopia. Though Boorstin didn't cite the specific statistics, Apptopia has recently [reported](#) that X downloads are down 30% in the two months after its rebrand from Twitter. Apptopia also reported decreased web traffic to X, and lower user numbers since before Twitter went public.

Around the time that Boorstin asked about daily active users, the air between the two turned somewhat hostile. Yaccarino came onstage already on the defensive, as the Code Conference added an interview with former Twitter trust and safety head Yoel Roth to the day's events at the last minute. Though Musk was fond of Roth at the beginning of his tenure at Twitter, Roth ended up leaving the company and was subject to serious threats and harassment, which Musk played no small part in.



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When asked about what advice he would give to Yaccarino, Roth had more to say about her own personal safety than her management of X. He said he was taken aback by a recent profile of Yaccarino,

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In which she opened up about the online attacks she’s weathered in her new role.

“Nobody should have to experience that. Not a CEO, not a journalist, not me. Not anybody.... Look what your boss did to me,” he said, referencing Musk’s role in his harassment, which became so extreme that he had to go into [hiding](#).

“It happened to me. It happened after he sang my praises publicly. It happened after I didn’t attack him. I didn’t attack the company. I quietly left,” Roth said, then spoke directly to Yaccarino. “For those that you love, you should be worried. I wish I had been more worried.”

[Twitter \(now X\) CEO Linda Yaccarino claims usage at ‘all time high’ in memo to staff](#)

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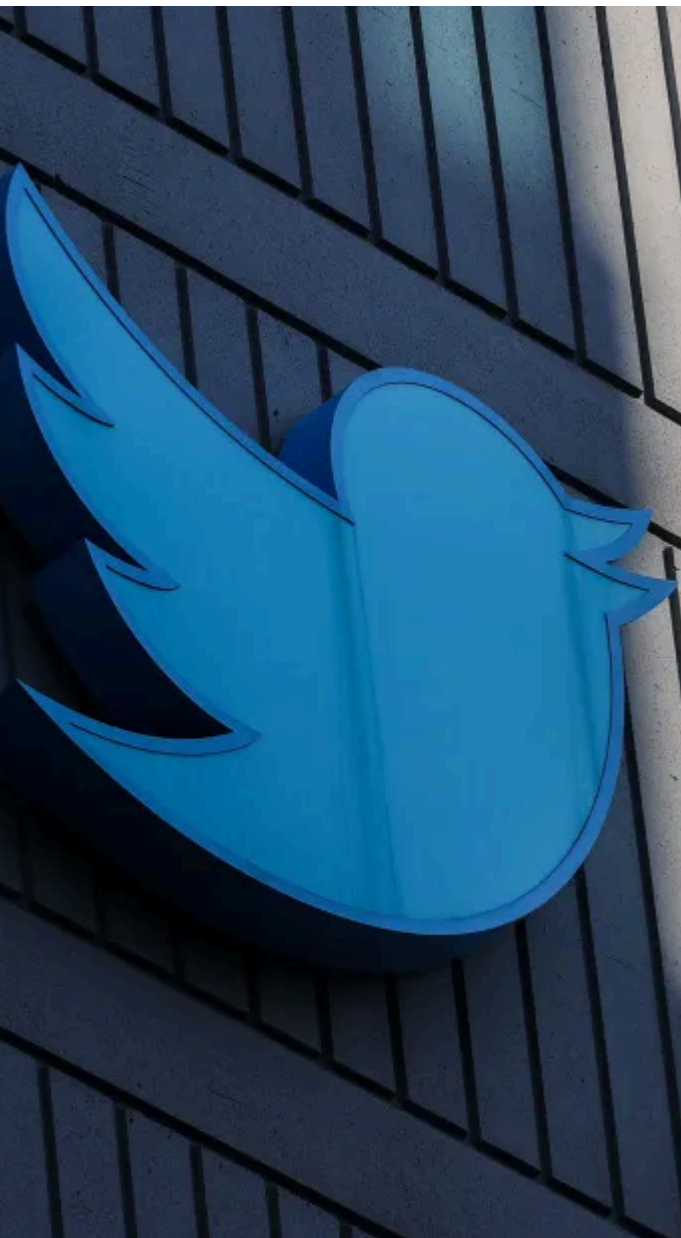


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Linda Yaccarino leaves NBCUniversal, adding fuel to the Twitter CEO fire

Ingrid Lunden, Amanda Silberling

6:36 AM PDT · May 12, 2023

IMAGE CREDITS:

TAYFUN COSKUN/ANADOLU AGENCY / GETTY IMAGES

Linda Yaccarino, the woman [hotly tipped as the next CEO of Twitter](#), has not made any statements confirming or denying the rumors. But she is definitely open to work: today, NBCUniversal, where she had been the chairman of its advertising and partnerships group, announced that she is leaving the company, effective immediately.

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“It has been an absolute honor to be part of Comcast NBCUniversal and lead the most incredible team,” she said in a statement. “We’ve transformed our company and the entire industry—and I am so proud of what we’ve accomplished together, and grateful to my colleagues and mentors, especially Brian Roberts, Mike Cavanagh and the entire NBCU leadership team.”

Mark Marshall, currently president of ad sales and client partnerships, is taking over the role on an interim basis.

The speculation over who would take over the CEO role Twitter kicked off yesterday, when Elon Musk, Twitter’s owner and current CEO, [announced](#) (on Twitter) that he’d found someone to take over the job, noting that “she will be starting in [about] six weeks.”

NBCU’s announcement will be seen by many as an indirect confirmation of the reports that Yaccarino will be the executive in question. It may even mean that an official Twitter announcement might come as soon as today.

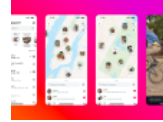
(The fact that Musk played by at least some semblance of rules here is interesting: Is that the new CEO’s influence at play already? NBCU was once a key media partner for Twitter in its heyday, so playing nice here and coordinating with their own media strategy might be a nod to that too.)

Putting an advertising supremo at the top of the company — Musk says he will stay on as chairman and “CTO, overseeing product, software & sysops” — is a no-brainer and a smart move, considering how dire things have been for the company on the business front since Musk took over last year.

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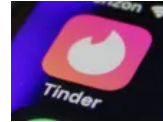
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Applying erratic policies to moderation, verification and other important aspects of Twitter's user environment and laying off an enormous proportion of its staff focused on all of those areas plus others critical to revenue generation (including its sales teams) the site has bled advertisers, and with that, revenues.

Now, the big question is whether it will be able to claw some of that back, and if so how it will do so without falling afoul of Musk, and Musk's accounting priorities.



Musk and Yaccarino already seem to have a bit of a rapport. Last month, Yaccarino interviewed Musk at an advertising conference in Miami, where she seemed complimentary of the business mogul.

“Elon has committed to being accessible to everyone for continual feedback,” she [said onstage](#). “He’s also opened up himself to also participate in the new transparency and safety rules he posted yesterday. Just remember, freedom of speech does not mean freedom of reach.”

She also pointed out to Elon that “the people in this room are [Twitter’s] path to profitability.” Since its inception, Twitter’s most effective way to make money has been [advertising](#), and Musk’s attempts to [monetize the blue check](#) have not been successful.

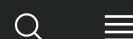
We don’t know whether the two of them were in negotiations at the time, but Yaccarino seemed motivated to sanitize the Twitter brand, encouraging audience members to voice their concerns to Musk in an Q&A.

Yaccarino could appear like a breath of fresh air compared to Musk, who is known to [post weed jokes](#) (and worse) late into the night. She knows the advertising business, and advertisers know her well, too. So, large brands would very likely be more comfortable advertising on a Twitter that she operates, rather than Musk. But per her own Twitter follows list, she seems to interface with the same controversial media brands that Musk promotes and follows, like conservative satire outlet The Babylon Bee (once [suspended](#) from Twitter for its transphobic jokes) and Chaya Raichik, who runs the [anti-LGBTQ+](#) social media account Libs of TikTok. This doesn’t necessarily mean Yaccarino endorses these views, but it’s an interesting data point given the [impact](#) Musk’s takeover has had on the [safety](#) of LGBTQ+ individuals on Twitter. And under Donald

Trump’s presidency, Yaccarino was [appointed](#) to the President’s Council on Sports, Fitness and Nutrition.

“If freedom of speech, as he says, is the bedrock of this country, I’m not sure there’s anyone in this room who could disagree with that,” Yaccarino said when interviewing Musk. “Could I get a round of applause for that?”

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Want to pay less for your X ads? Just place them next to spam

Amanda Silberling — 8:41 AM PDT · August 9, 2023

X [says](#) it has “delivered a decade’s worth of innovation focused on creating an engaging and healthy environment” since Elon Musk’s acquisition. Sure!

Everyone knows that when you think about X, you immediately think of ~~closing a tab the twenty fourth letter of the alphabet~~ ~~porn Ed Sheeran’s second studio album, X, which peaked at #1 on the Billboard 200~~ brand safety. So, under advertising veteran and new Twitter X CEO Linda Yaccarino, the social platform is throwing a Hail Mary to appeal to advertisers, who have [largely fled X](#) since it was sold to Elon Musk.

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X is expanding its partnership with [Integral Ad Science \(IAS\)](#), which it [began working with](#) in January to tell advertisers if their ad is placed around inappropriate content. Now, X is testing sensitivity settings, powered by machine learning, that let advertisers choose their thresholds for the kinds of content they want their ads to appear around — and according to a tweet from X owner Elon Musk, advertisers can buy these less desirable, “relaxed” sensitivity ad slots for less.

“I would recommend advertisers not be super concerned about content adjacency,” Musk [wrote](#). “Tesla and SpaceX are not and the ‘less desirable’ ad inventory is much cheaper!”

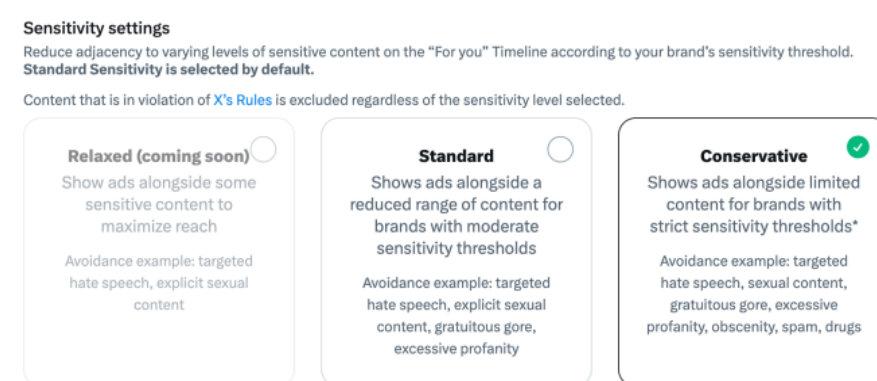


IMAGE CREDITS: X

In the most conservative setting, brands can reduce adjacency to gore, excessive profanity and obscenity, targeted hate speech, sexual content, drugs and spam. However, X’s AI moderation tools have proven deeply unskillful at detecting [spam](#), so it’s a good thing that X is claiming to “reduce,” rather than “eliminate” adjacency to such content. Soon, X will add its “relaxed” setting, which offers cheaper advertising opportunities while only filtering for targeted hate speech and explicit sexual content.

To be fair, it’s basic economics. If you have more supply than demand, lower your prices... and also lower the quality of your product, I guess.

[How far have Twitter’s advertising revenues fallen?](#)

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Twitter partners with DoubleVerify and IAS on brand safety initiative amid advertiser exits

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Apple, Disney, Comcast among X advertisers pausing spending after Musk endorsed antisemitic post

Amanda Silberling — 7:55 AM PST · November 20, 2023

After X owner Elon Musk amplified antisemitic conspiracy theories on the platform, numerous high-profile advertisers have paused their spending on the platform formerly known as Twitter.

Since Friday, per [various news reports](#), the following advertisers have paused their spending on X advertisements:

Apple

Comcast/NBCUniversal

Disney

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Per research from the Center for Countering Digital Hate, X has [failed to moderate](#) hate speech on its platform that promotes antisemitic conspiracies, praises Hitler and dehumanizes Muslims and Palestinians. But X isn’t just keeping these posts up; its owner, Elon Musk, is fanning the flames of such hatred. In a particularly egregious incident last week, Musk replied, “[You have said the actual truth](#)” to a post that echoed the same violent antisemitic conspiracy theory that was espoused by the killer from the 2018 [Tree of Life synagogue](#) attack.

[Backlash builds after Elon Musk called an antisemitic conspiracy theory the ‘actual truth’](#)

Media Matters for America, a left-leaning media watchdog, [published a separate report last week](#), showing how ads from companies like Apple, IBM, Bravo, Oracle and Xfinity have appeared next to posts that praise Nazi ideology. In a statement, X said that the report “completely misrepresented the real user experience on X, in another attempt to undermine freedom of speech and mislead advertisers.” Throughout his tenure as X’s owner, Musk has sued or threatened to sue nonprofit organizations like the [Center for Countering Digital Hate](#) and the [Anti-Defamation League](#), alleging that their reports are responsible for the increasingly tenuous relationship between X and advertisers.

“The split second court opens on Monday, X Corp will be filing a thermonuclear lawsuit against Media Matters and ALL those who colluded in this

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fraudulent attack on our company,” Musk wrote in a post on X.



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In a statement that Musk posted, X claims that Media Matters deceived advertisers and engineered a contrived experience on the platform in order to view ads alongside antisemitic content. Media Matters highlighted nine posts that the organization believes should violate X’s content policies, but X said only one post was found to be in violation and taken down. X seems to have suspended an account that denied the historical legitimacy of the Holocaust, but did not take action against a post that refers to Nazism as a “spiritual awakening,” or posts that praise white supremacist Nazi ideals.

The split second court opens on Monday, X Corp will be filing a thermonuclear lawsuit against Media Matters and ALL those who colluded in this fraudulent attack on our company

pic.twitter.com/55vl7PspaQ

— Elon Musk (@elonmusk) [November 18, 2023](#)

Linda Yaccarino, X's new CEO and former advertising executive at NBCUniversal, has attempted to calm advertisers, though her efforts don't seem to be working, as advertisers continue to pause spending.

"X's point of view has always been very clear that discrimination by everyone should STOP across the board — I think that's something we can and should all agree on," she wrote on Thursday afternoon.

"When it comes to this platform — X has also been extremely clear about our efforts to combat antisemitism and discrimination. There's no place for it anywhere in the world — it's ugly and wrong. Full stop."

X's point of view has always been very clear that discrimination by everyone should STOP across the board — I think that's something we can and should all agree on. When it comes to this platform — X has also been extremely clear about our efforts to combat antisemitism and...

— Linda Yaccarino (@lindayaX) [November 16, 2023](#)

X's advertising business has been [volatile](#) since last year, when Elon Musk officially became the owner of the platform formerly known as Twitter. About a month after he took over, Musk tweeted that Apple had "[mostly stopped advertising on Twitter](#)." But after [meeting with Apple CEO Tim Cook](#) at the company's Cupertino headquarters, the two seemed to settle some disagreements. Then, in January, the company inked deals with adtech companies [DoubleVerify](#) and [Integral Ad Science \(IAS\)](#) to help advertisers make sure their ad is not placed around inappropriate content, and the [appointment of Yaccarino](#) in May was supposed to assuage advertiser's concerns about the increasingly hostile platform. But Musk continues to

dig the platform's own grave by alienating key revenue drivers.

The Biden White House releases a statement on Elon Musk pic.twitter.com/QZJnJuRT2K

— Aaron Blake (@AaronBlake) [November 17, 2023](#)

As Musk continues to entertain antisemitic conspiracies, the White House weighed in with a [statement](#) condemning the promotion of antisemitic and racist hate.

“It is unacceptable to repeat the hideous lie behind the most fatal act of Antisemitism in American history at any time, let alone one month after the deadliest day for the Jewish people since the Holocaust,” wrote White House spokesperson Andrew Bates. “We condemn this abhorrent promotion of Antisemitic and racist hate in the strongest terms, which runs against our core values as Americans.”

Update, 11/20/23 at 11:00 AM ET, with information about additional advertisers pausing spending.

[Elon Musk's Twitter hit with Holocaust denial hate speech lawsuit in Germany](#)

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